

Professional Skills I: Presenting Lecture Notes, Day 3

Main point of this session:

Vocal variation - the technique by which a speaker keeps a listener engaged. Point of view - the technique by which we name the character's relationship to what they are saying in a given phrase. Can be characterized by introspection vs communication and vocal dynamics (pitch, rhythm, volume).

Learning objectives for today:

- Acting the behavior of thinking
- Vocal Variation
- Point of View
- Introspection/Communication;
- Vocal Dynamics. Pitch, Rhythm, Volume

Meditation session (10 min)

Lie down

Stretch and get comfortable

Close your eyes, or keep them open if you prefer

enter a state of embodiment without interruption from the language-based, intellectual mind

feel your breath...

If a thought comes into your mind, recognize it and let it go...

Feel the ground beneath you supporting you...

If any of your muscles are tense, try to relax them: relax your face, ears, chin, neck, shoulder blades, spine, core, arms, legs, ankles, toes.

Now, if you've had your eyes closed, open them

Let your eyes softly gaze around the room, noticing shapes, color, and texture...

Now find a spot on the wall or ceiling, and let your eyes rest there...

Review (5 minutes)

Concentration. Why is it useful? Relaxation. Why is it useful? Meaningful gesture. Home bases. Theatrical Sphere of Expression. Phrasing. Breathing during phrasing. Acting the behavior of thinking.

Acting the behavior of thinking (5 minutes)

Together with our phrases, we must act out the behavior accompanying the character's thought process.

This process is also extremely helpful to “reset” your emotion/face after every phrase to prepare for the new phrase.

Exercise (20 minutes)

Everybody gets up all at once, practices concentration and relaxation for 10 seconds, and then speaks. Students speak the first three sentences of their texts, exercising phrasing, and theatrical sphere of expression, while not forgetting concentration and relaxation.

Then, students all sit down. One student comes up at a time, in front of us, and speaks the first three sentences of their text, practicing concentration, relaxation, phrasing, and theatrical sphere of expression.

— BREAK (5 minutes) —

[V] Vocal Variation (5 minutes)

Vocal variation - the technique by which a speaker keeps a listener engaged; the technique by which a speaker helps the listener understand the content and structure of a speech; the technique by which an actor makes distinct, dynamic shifts in vocal and acting choices from phrase to phrase

Elements of Vocal Variation (5 minutes)

Point of view - the technique by which we name the character's relationship to what they are saying in a given phrase.

Demo (with & without VV) (5 minutes)

GPT prompts. Instructors demonstrate the use of points of view.

Elements of Vocal Variation (15 minutes)

Introspection / communication - any point of view can be played in one of two directions: an introspective acting choice has the quality of still being in process, or more for the speaker than for the listener; a communicative acting choice has the quality of being fully processed and for the listener more than the speaker

DEMO

Vocal Dynamics - pitch, rhythm and volume

DEMO

Exercise (together) (30 minutes)

Go through a couple of sentences of the GPT prompts, making notes about how to incorporate VV and phrasing.